STUDENT'S ID NO:_____ SIGNATURE: _____

UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

(**All rights reserved**)

DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION

SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP

COLLEGES OF EDUCATION

END OF SEMESTER ONE EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 200, 2024/2025

B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: TEEG 201

COURSE TITLE: EARLY GRADE EDUCATION

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.

Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

[25 Marks]

Answer **all** the questions in this section.

1. A new early grade teacher observes students from diverse cultural backgrounds in their classroom. According to the course material, what is the most appropriate philosophical approach to adopt?
   A. Focus only on academic content
   B. Separate students by cultural background
   C. Integrate developmentally appropriate practices with cultural sensitivity
   D. Ignore cultural differences entirely

2. Early grade education in Ghana is primarily focused on ages 4-8 years.
   A. True
   B. False

3. What is the primary goal of early grade teacher education?
   A. To focus solely on academic achievement and co-curricular activities
   B. To equip teachers with knowledge of how children grow, develop and learn
   C. To teach basic classroom management and thinking strategies
   D. To prepare teachers for lower and upper primary levels

4. During a school visit, you notice that some early grade teachers have little or no training in early childhood education. What does this observation reflect about the field?
   A. It is not important to have specialized training
   B. Anyone can teach early grades
   C. It represents a key challenge in early grade education in Ghana
   D. It is the preferred teaching model

5. Early grade education is exclusively a female profession.
   A. True, only women should teach early grades
   B. False, this is identified as a misconception that needs to be addressed
   D. False, but only men should teach early grades

6. You are developing an early grade curriculum. According to the foundational principles discussed, what should be your primary consideration?
   A. Focus only on academic skills
   B. Emphasize rote learning
   C. Create play-oriented and hands-on activities
   D. Minimize physical activities

7. What role does the National Literacy Accelerated Programme (NALAP) play in early grade education?
   A. It focuses only on mathematics
   B. It equips teachers with tools and skills for delivery in L1
   C. It provides only financial support
   D. It trains administrators only

8. An early grade classroom has limited resources and facilities. Based on the course content, what should be the teacher's approach?
   A. Give up and wait for better resources
   B. Only teach theory
   C. Develop innovative ways to overcome the challenges
   D. Reduce class size

9. The course manual indicates that early grade teachers don't need special skills or training.
   A. True, anyone can teach early grades
   B. False, this is identified as a misconception about early grade education
   C. True, if they have teaching experience
   D. False, but only administrative skills are needed

STUDENT'S ID NO:_____ SIGNATURE: _____

10. You observe children from different socioeconomic backgrounds in your class. What approach should you take?
    A. Focus on wealthy students
    B. Separate students by background
    C. Create inclusive learning opportunities for all
    D. Ignore the differences

11. Which key principle of Pestalozzi is emphasized in early grade education?
    A. Focus only on academic achievement
    B. The development of Head, Heart, and Hands
    C. Strict discipline only
    D. Theoretical learning only

12. A student shows advanced abilities in some areas but struggles in others. According to the course principles, what approach should be taken?
    A. Focus only on weaknesses
    B. Develop a holistic approach considering all developmental areas
    C. Ignore the strengths
    D. Move the student to a higher grade

13. What is identified as a core transferable skill in the course manual?
    A. Only digital literacy
    B. Only communication
    C. Critical thinking and collaboration
    D. Only administrative skills

14. Play-based learning has no educational value.
    A. True, it is just for fun
    B. False, play is recognized as a crucial learning approach
    C. True, it wastes time
    D. False, but it should be minimal

15. You are planning activities for early grade learners. What should be your primary consideration?
    A. Focus only on writing
    B. Consider developmentally appropriate practices
    C. Use only textbooks
    D. Minimize active learning

STUDENT'S ID NO:_____ SIGNATURE: _____

16. What is emphasized about assessment in early grade education?
    A. Only end-of-term exams matter
    B. No assessment is needed
    C. Continuous and varied assessment methods are important
    D. Only written tests should be used

17. A child struggles with the language of instruction. What approach is recommended?
    A. Exclude them from activities
    B. Use only English
    C. Implement appropriate language support strategies
    D. Ignore the challenge

18. What role do ICT resources play in early childhood education?
    A. They should never be used
    B. They should be integrated into teaching and learning
    C. They are only for teachers
    D. They are only for administrative purposes

19. Large class sizes are ideal for early grade education.
    A. True, they promote better learning
    B. False, they are identified as a challenge to be managed
    C. True, they are cost-effective
    D. False, but they don't affect learning

20. Parents show little involvement in their children's early grade education. What does the course manual identify this as?
    A. A positive situation
    B. An ideal scenario
    C. A significant challenge in early grade education
    D. The preferred approach

21. During a school visit, you observe an early grade teacher implementing Pestalozzi's principles. Which approach should be evident in their teaching?
    A. Focus only on academic content
    B. Integration of Head, Heart, and Hands development
    C. Emphasis on rote learning only
    D. Exclusive focus on physical activities

22. Which key contribution did Elizabeth Peabody make to early grade education according to the course material?
    A. Focus on standardized testing
    B. Emphasis on adult-centered learning
    C. Development of child-centered approaches
    D. Promotion of rigid classroom structures

23. A teacher is planning to implement Montessori's principles in their early grade classroom. What should be their primary focus?
    A. Teacher-directed learning only
    B. Prepared environment and child independence
    C. Strict discipline and control
    D. Whole class instruction only

24. According to the course material, the NALAP program in Ghana focuses only on mathematics instruction.
    A. True, it's mathematics-focused
    B. False, it equips teachers with L1 delivery tools and skills
    C. True, but includes some reading
    D. False, it's only for upper primary

25. You observe varying levels of language development in your early grade classroom. Based on Chomsky's principles, what approach should you take?
    A. Ignore language differences
    B. Focus only on written language
    C. Recognize innate language acquisition abilities
    D. Use only English instruction

SECTION B

[75 Marks]

Answer any **three** (3) questions in this section.

Question 1 **(20 Marks)**

a) Define Early Grade Education and explain its scope. (5 marks)
b) Discuss at least three key principles underlying early grade education. (6 marks)
c) Explain why early grade education is critical to a child's development. (5 marks)

d) Identify and discuss two challenges faced in the implementation of early grade education in Ghana. (4 marks)

Question 2 **(20 Marks)**

a) Explain the contributions of Froebel and Montessori to early grade education. (6 marks)
b) Compare and contrast the principles of Piaget and Vygotsky in relation to early childhood learning. (8 marks)
c) How have the principles of these founders influenced the development of early grade education in Ghana? (6 marks)

Question 3 **(20 Marks)**

a) Identify three common misconceptions about early grade education. (6 marks)
b) Discuss how societal biases influence the perception of early childhood education teachers. (6 marks)
c) Propose 4 strategies to address misconceptions and biases towards early childhood education. (8 marks)

Question 4 **(20 Marks)**

a) Discuss three effective teaching strategies for early grade learners. (6 marks)
b) Explain the role of play-based learning in early childhood education. (6 marks)
c) How can an early grade teacher integrate ICT into classroom teaching to enhance learning? (8 marks)

Question 5 **(20 Marks)**

a) Identify and explain two major infrastructural challenges in early grade education. (6 marks)
b) How does a lack of parental involvement affect early childhood learning outcomes? (6 marks)
c) Suggest 4 practical ways to overcome these challenges and improve early childhood education in Ghana. (8 marks)